

Childhood

1. What according to the poem is involved in the process of growing up?

Answer: Growing up, according to the poem, entails the development of mental maturity as well as the loss of innocence and simplicity. When a person has become logical, sensible, and capable of constructing his own thoughts, he is said to have matured. A mature person can tell the difference between reality and fiction. A mature person is aware of other people's activities, just as the poet is aware of the gap between the two. The grownups' preaching and practice. The grownups' duplicity and false standards become apparent to him. A mature person also expresses his ideas and opinions.

2. What is the poet's feeling towards childhood?

Answer: Childhood, according to the poet, is a time of purity and simplicity, a time when one trusts others without questioning their motives. He doesn't appear to be sad or distressed at the death of his mother. In his formative years, He just appears to be perplexed by the situation. The end of childhood and the beginning of adulthood. When he asks the questions, he expresses his perplexity. 'When did my childhood end?' and 'Where did my childhood go?'

3. What did the speaker learn about the existence of Heaven and Hell?

Answer: As the speaker grew to be mature, he acquired reasoning power. He realized that Hell and Heaven could not be found in Geography books or Atlas. Since they could not be located anywhere in the world map, he concluded that they did not exist. He would believe only what he could see and find.

4. How did the speaker realise the hypocrisy of the adults?

Answer: The speaker noticed a wide gulf between what adults appeared to be and what they actually were in real life. There was apparent contradiction between their words and deeds. They talked of love and advised others to love, but they never acted lovingly.

5. Which, do you think are the most poetic lines? Why?

Answer: The following lines in the poem are most poetic: It went to some forgotten place that's hidden in an infant's face, That's all I know. These lines beautifully sum up the process of growth and the disappearance of a particular stage of life. These lines have a figurative or metaphorical meaning also. The infant's innocent face hides many things behind its smiles. Perhaps the childhood lies hidden in some forgotten place lying buried deep inside a child's consciousness.

6. 'Childhood is an essential state in the process of growing up, but it can't go on forever.' Discuss.

Answer: Childhood is an important stage in the process of growing up for every person. The human infant is totally dependent on others, but during childhood he gains physical, emotional and mental strength. As the tiny baby grows bigger in size, other faculties also develop. This stage is an important landmark in man's growth, but it can't go on forever. Childhood being a stage, must give way to another stage. It is followed by adolescence or early youth. Now all the faculties are fully developed. The person acquires reasoning power. His rationalism helps him to decide truth or falsehood, fact and fiction. He acquires a fine capability of analysis and discrimination. Now he can see through people and things. He begins to understand the hypocrisy of adults. He gains confidence and becomes an independent thinker.